

DIGITALAIKART

The Diwali 2026

Home & Budget Playbook

Plan, budget and celebrate Diwali without the last-minute panic.

5-DAY
FESTIVAL

3 BUDGET
TIERS

12 AI
PROMPTS

6-WEEK
PLANNER

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How to use this playbook

Diwali 2026 falls on Sunday, 8 November. The festival runs five days, from Dhanteras on Friday, 6 November to Bhai Dooj on Tuesday, 10 November. That is roughly six weeks from the day this edition was written — enough time to plan well, and not enough time to leave everything to the last weekend.

Most Diwali stress does not come from a lack of money. It comes from spending without a plan: the gift you forgot, the sweets ordered twice, the decor bought in a panic at a marked-up price, the cracker bill nobody tracked. This playbook fixes that with numbers, dates and checklists you can use today.

What you get inside

- **The real 2026 calendar** — the exact five days, the puja window, and why a Sunday Diwali changes your delivery deadlines.
- **A budget that holds** — three ready-made household tiers, a line-by-line allocation, and the four festive traps that quietly blow budgets.
- **The sale-date strategy** — verified Amazon and Flipkart festive sale dates, the actual bank offers, and how to spot a fake discount.
- **A gifting plan** — rupee bands by relationship, gifts people actually keep, and the tax rules if you gift at the office.
- **Home prep, hosting and a menu** — a week-by-week cleaning plan, decor price bands, and per-guest quantities so you cook the right amount.
- **Green, safe and pet-friendly Diwali** — what the Supreme Court decided for 2026, cracker rules, fire safety and burn first-aid.
- **A 6-week countdown** and **12 AI prompts** to plan your budget, menu, gifts and decor in minutes.

Every fact, date, price band and rule in this playbook was checked against official and reputable sources in late September and early October 2026. The full source list is at the end. Because Diwali dates and sale dates are fixed once announced, everything here stays valid through the festival.

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1 · The Diwali 2026 Calendar

Diwali is a five-day festival, not a single night. Knowing what happens on which day tells you when to shop, when to send gifts, and when to host. Here are the dates for 2026, computed for Indian cities.

Day	Date (2026)	Festival	What it means
1	Fri, 6 Nov	Dhanteras	The buying day. Auspicious for gold, silver, utensils and new things. Lakshmi and Kubera are worshipped in the evening; diya-lighting begins.
2	Sat, 7 Nov	Kali Chaudas / Choti Diwali	Naraka Chaturdashi. Homes are cleaned, rangolis drawn, and the first round of diyas and sweets appears.
3	Sun, 8 Nov	Diwali / Lakshmi Puja	The main day. Lakshmi-Ganesh puja is performed after sunset in Pradosh Kaal. The biggest night for family gifting and fireworks.
4	Mon, 9 Nov	Govardhan Puja / Gujarati New Year	Annakut and Bestu Varas. A day for community, neighbours and the new year for many Gujarati families.
5	Tue, 10 Nov	Bhai Dooj	Sisters apply tilak for their brothers; brothers give gifts. The close of the festival week.

A few regional panchangs place Bhai Dooj on 11 November and begin festivities on Govatsa Dwadashi (5 November) in Maharashtra. Confirm the exact tithi and puja window with your local panchang — the muhurat shifts by city.

The Lakshmi Puja window

Lakshmi Puja is done in Pradosh Kaal, the period beginning at sunset, ideally in a fixed (sthir) lagna. For New Delhi on 8 November 2026, the main puja window runs roughly 5:54 PM to 7:50 PM IST, with a broader Pradosh window around 5:30 PM to 8:05 PM. Exact timings differ city to city, so check your own panchang on the day. Diyas are traditionally lit from Dhanteras itself.

Why a Sunday Diwali matters in 2026

- **The long weekend works in your favour for celebrating, but against you for deliveries.** With Diwali on Sunday, Choti Diwali on Saturday and Govardhan Puja on Monday, many offices close from Friday to Tuesday.
- **Friday, 6 November is the last useful working day** before the festival. Anything meant to be handed over in person at an office should reach by Thursday, 5 November so it can be distributed.
- **Send out-of-city gifts early.** Courier networks congest badly in the final fortnight. Aim for gifts to land between 3 and 5 November — before Dhanteras, not on the day.
- **Shop the sales, not the last week.** The big festive sales open on 8–9 October (see Chapter 3). Buying then beats the price spikes of the final ten days.

Rule of thumb: work backwards from Thursday, 5 November — not from Sunday, 8 November. That single change is what stops the last-minute scramble.

2 · Set Your Diwali Budget

A Diwali budget is not about spending less. It is about deciding the total first, then dividing it, so the gift list and the decor list stop competing with each other. Pick the tier closest to your household, adjust the numbers, and write it down before you buy a single thing.

Step 1 — Pick your total

Tier	Total	Best for	Per-head spend
Lean	₹10,000	Small family, tight month, first job, or a rented room	₹300–500
Standard	₹25,000	Most middle-class households — family gifts, decor, hosting	₹700–1,200
Grand	₹50,000	Big family, several gift recipients, a proper party	₹1,500–2,500

Step 2 — Split it by head

These shares work across all three tiers. Change them to suit your year — for example, shift 5% from clothes to gifts if you are hosting a big party.

Head	Share	Lean	Standard	Grand	What it covers
Gifts & mithai	30%	₹3,000	₹7,500	₹15,000	Family, friends, staff, neighbours, office
Clothes & personal	20%	₹2,000	₹5,000	₹10,000	New clothes for the family
Home & decor	15%	₹1,500	₹3,750	₹7,500	Diyas, lights, rangoli, toran, cleaning
Food & hosting	15%	₹1,500	₹3,750	₹7,500	Party menu, sweets, groceries, drinks
Puja & essentials	10%	₹1,000	₹2,500	₹5,000	Puja items, pooja thali, new account book
Crackers	5%	₹500	₹1,250	₹2,500	Green crackers only (see Chapter 7)
Buffer	5%	₹500	₹1,250	₹2,500	The thing you always forget

A blank version of this worksheet is in Chapter 10 — print it or fill it on your phone.

Step 3 — Know the four traps

- **The “muhurat” mark-up.** Festive “making charges” on gold and “festival special” prices are sometimes higher than off-season rates. A plain 22K chain should be about 8–12% making; a gold coin about 2–5%. If it is far more, ask why.

- **“No-cost” EMI is still a loan.** Zero interest is not zero cost — there can be processing fees and, if you clear it early, foreclosure charges. Take it only for something you were going to buy anyway.
- **Sweets creep.** Buying mithai for gifting and for home separately doubles the bill. Decide the total sweet quantity once, then split it.
- **Last-week pricing.** Decor and gifts cost the most in the final ten days, when choice is lowest and demand is highest. Shop the October sales window instead.

3 · The Festive Shopping Calendar & Sale Strategy

The two biggest Indian festive sales both open in the second week of October 2026 — weeks before Diwali. Buying during them, with the right card, is the single easiest way to cut your Diwali bill. Here are the confirmed dates and the offers that actually apply.

The confirmed sale dates

Sale	Opens	Early access	Bank / card offer
Amazon Great Indian Festival	8 October 2026	Prime members (check the app for the hour)	SBI credit & debit cards — 10% instant discount, incl. eligible EMI; a separate 35% cashback offer capped at ₹150; Amazon Pay Later 10% cashback; Amazon Pay ICICI 5% cashback
Flipkart Big Billion Days	9 October 2026	8 October for Plus, Black & VIP members and Flipkart credit-card holders	Axis Bank & ICICI Bank — up to 10% instant discount on eligible cards; super.money 10% cashback (first transaction only)

Both sales run into the Diwali period. Note that bank offers are “up to” a cap — the maximum rupee discount is set per category and shown at checkout, not in the banner.

How to spot a fake discount

- **Track the price for two weeks.** Note the price of anything you want now. A “60% off” tag means nothing if the price was inflated the week before.
- **Check the discount cap, not the percentage.** “Up to 10%” with a ₹1,500 cap is worth far less on a cheap item than a costly one. The real saving is the capped rupee amount.
- **Compare across both apps** before you buy. The same phone, appliance or appliance-accessory is rarely cheapest on the same platform twice.
- **Read the exchange offer fine print.** Exchange values vary by model and condition, and are quoted as a maximum.

Buying gold or silver on Dhanteras (6 Nov)

Dhanteras is the traditional day to buy gold, silver and new utensils. Protect yourself with five checks:

Check	What to do
BIS hallmark + HUID	Every piece must carry the BIS hallmark and a 6-digit HUID code. Verify it in the showroom on the BIS Care app.
Making charges	Ask for the making charge before you pay. Plain 22K jewellery is about 8–12%; coins about 2–5%; intricate handcrafted pieces can reach 20–30%.

Check	What to do
GST	Gold, coins and bars attract 3% GST on the total. It should appear separately on the bill.
Cash above ₹2 lakh	PAN is mandatory. Insist on a detailed invoice showing purity, weight, making charge, GST and the HUID number.
What to avoid	Unhallmarked gold, inflated “muhurat” making charges, and stone or diamond prices bundled into the gold weight.

From 14 September 2026, BIS raised the gold hallmarking fee to ₹75 per article (silver stays ₹35). This is paid by the jeweller, not you — but it is one more reason to buy only from registered, hallmarking-compliant shops.

4 · The Gifting Plan

Diwali gifting fails in two ways: spending too much on the wrong people, and giving the same forgettable box everyone else gives. Fix both with a simple band per relationship and a rule for what to give.

Spend bands by relationship

Recipient	Band	What works
Parents, in-laws, close family	₹1,500–5,000	Presentation matters more than variety. One considered item beats a padded hamper.
Colleagues, neighbours, acquaintances	₹500–1,500	A good dry-fruit or mithai box, artisan food, or a nice diya set.
Domestic staff, drivers, security	₹200–500	A smaller box in good packaging looks considered without being excessive.
Children	Token	A small toy, book or chocolate set — keep it simple and useful.

The one rule that makes a gift memorable

Utility beats novelty. The gift that gets used every day — insulated drinkware, a good artisan food hamper, a wellness set, a nice desk item — outlives the gift that impresses once. Sweets are eaten and forgotten, and a plain dry-fruit box is often re-gifted. If you are giving a hamper, make one item genuinely good rather than padding the box to hit a price.

The personal gifting timeline

- **By 10 October:** finalise your recipient list and band per person.
- **Mid-October:** order personal gifts during the sales (Chapter 3). Out-of-city orders first.
- **By 24 October:** order anything customised or personalised — these need the most lead time.
- **Last week of October:** the last safe window for standard delivery. Popular hampers start selling out.
- **1–5 November:** delivery window. Aim for gifts to arrive before Dhanteras (6 November).

If you gift at the office (or run a small business)

Corporate and office gifting has its own numbers. Keep these in mind so your gesture stays clean and budgeted:

- **Per-head budget:** ₹500–2,000 per person covers the vast majority of Indian programmes. ₹1,000–2,000 is the premium sweet spot where you can give one genuinely good item.
- **Perquisite rule:** gifts in kind up to ₹5,000 per employee per financial year are generally not treated as a taxable perquisite (Rule 3(7)(iv)). Above that, the excess is typically added to the employee's taxable salary.
- **GST:** input tax credit is generally not available on goods disposed of as gifts (Section 17(5)(h) of the CGST Act). Budget on a GST-inclusive basis and ask your vendor for a

proper tax invoice.

- **Order early:** customised bulk orders need 7-25 days, and courier networks congest in the final fortnight. Lock orders by early October.

Add a personal touch for free: a handwritten card, a small homemade sweet box, or a photo gift costs little and is remembered longest.

5 · Home Prep & Decor on a Budget

A Diwali-ready home is more about sequence than spending. Clean first, declutter second, decorate third — in that order. Decorating a cluttered room wastes both the decor and the money.

The week-by-week home plan

When	Focus	Tasks
3-4 weeks before	Declutter	Clear one room a week. Sort into keep, give, and sell or discard. Donate old clothes, books and toys.
2 weeks before	Deep clean	Cupboards, kitchen shelves, fans, curtains, sofas, balconies. Wash and air bedding. Clean the puja area.
1 week before	Repair & replace	Fix leaking taps, flickering lights and broken handles. Replace burnt-out bulbs with warm-white LEDs.
3-4 days before	Decorate	Hang lights, toran and rangoli. Set out diyas and candles. Arrange the puja thali and sweets.
Diwali day	Finish	Final dusting, fresh flowers, light the diyas at dusk, and set out the rangoli near the entrance.

Decor shopping list with price bands

Item	Typical price band	Tip
Clay diyas (pack)	₹50-300	Buy in bulk; clay beats plastic for looks and for the planet.
LED fairy / string lights	₹150-600	Warm white looks richer than multi-colour. Check for BIS mark.
Toran / door hanging	₹100-300	Marigold or fabric torans can be reused next year.
Rangoli colours	₹100-400	Or use rice flour, flower petals and pulses — free and natural.
Floating candles / tea lights	₹100-350	Pair with a bowl of water for a premium look at low cost.
Fresh flowers (marigold)	₹100-250 / kg	Buy on the morning of 7-8 November for the best price.

Price bands are indicative retail ranges for 2026 and vary by city and quality.

Six DIY decor ideas that look expensive

- Floating diyas: a wide bowl, water, a few flower petals and tea lights.
- Marigold strings: thread fresh marigold heads on a cotton string for a toran that smells as good as it looks.
- Upcycled jar lanterns: clean glass jars, a tea light inside, a ribbon around the neck.

- Rice-flour rangoli: draw the outline with a sieve of rice flour, fill with petals and pulses.
- Mirror and diya thali: arrange diyas in a circle on a steel thali with kumkum and rice for a rich puja display.
- Warm-white only: mixing warm and cool white lights looks cluttered. Stick to warm white for a premium finish.

Safety first with lights: use BIS-marked LED sets, do not overload a single socket, keep lights away from curtains and fabric, and switch off before sleeping. LED diyas near fabric are safer than open flame.

6 · The Hosting & Menu Planner

The biggest hosting mistake is cooking too much of the wrong thing. Decide the format, then the menu, then the quantities — in that order. Everything below is built around real per-guest numbers.

Pick your format first

- **Open house:** guests drop in over a few hours. Go heavy on snacks, chaat and sweets; light on a sit-down main course.
- **Sit-down dinner:** a fixed guest list at a fixed time. You need a full main course and controlled quantities.
- **Card party / friends' night:** snacks and drinks run the evening. Plan a big snack spread and one dessert.

A reliable Diwali menu template

Course	How many	Examples
Welcome drink	1-2	Masala chaas, jal jeera, rose sherbet, mocktail
Starters	3-4	Paneer tikka, samosa, dahi ke kebab, cutlets
Chaat counter	1-2	Pani puri, dahi puri, bhel — a crowd favourite
Main course	2 veg + 1 non-veg (optional)	Paneer dish, dal, a seasonal sabzi, chicken or mutton curry
Rice & bread	1-2 each	Jeera rice or pulao; roti, naan or puri
Sweets	2	One mithai + one quick dessert (kheer, halwa, gulab jamun)
Sides	2-3	Raita, salad, papad, pickle

How much to cook — per guest

Item	Per guest	Note
Starters / snacks	4-6 pieces	More for an open house, fewer for a sit-down dinner
Main course (cooked)	350-400 g	Across all mains combined
Rice / bread	1 cup rice or 3-4 rotis	Depends on the crowd
Sweets	2 pieces or 1 small bowl	Add a little extra for gifting
Drinks	2-3 glasses	Include a non-alcoholic option for everyone

Round up. It is better to have a little extra than to run short on the one night guests remember.

The prep timeline

- **3 days before:** finalise the guest count and menu. Shop for dry goods, sweets and non-perishables.
- **2 days before:** marinate and prep; make sweets that keep well; clean and set the serving area.
- **1 day before:** buy fresh vegetables, paneer and flowers. Prep the chaat counter components.
- **Party day:** cook mains in the morning, keep warm; assemble chaat and starters just before guests arrive.

Budget swap: one shop-bought mithai plus one homemade dessert costs less than two shop-bought sweets and often tastes better. For gifting mithai, buy one large quantity and split it into boxes rather than buying separate gift packs.

7 · Green, Safe & Pet-Friendly Diwali

Cracker rules change every year, so this chapter is based on what the Supreme Court decided in late September 2026 — days before this edition went out. Read it before you buy crackers or plan the evening.

What the Supreme Court decided for 2026

- On 30 September 2026, the Supreme Court ruled out a **nationwide total ban** on firecrackers, and equally ruled out **unrestricted 24-hour bursting**. It said it would consider **specified time windows** and specify which crackers may be used.
- The Court accepted the government's recommendation to allow **next-generation (Gen-2) joined "green" crackers**, subject to conditions — smaller shell size, fewer and slower bursts, no banned chemicals, and noise within **125 dB(AI) / 145 dB(C) peak**.
- Only manufacturers licensed by the **Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation (PESO)** and registered with **CSIR-NEERI** may make them.
- The question of **barium** in Gen-2 crackers is still under test; field studies in Bhopal, Delhi, Kolkata and Chennai were due by 15 October 2026. The Delhi-NCR rules were deferred to a separate bench and were still pending at the time of writing.
- Practical takeaway: check the latest local order and your city's allowed bursting hours before Diwali night. Delhi-NCR rules are stricter than the rest of the country and can change.

What "green cracker" actually means

CSIR-NEERI's data shows the Gen-2 joined crackers cut particulate emissions (PM10 and PM2.5) by roughly 45-60% in lab tests, about 30% lower emissions overall, and 4-32% less solid waste. They burst five braids a second instead of 25, stretching the burn about fivefold. The label is a relative claim, not a promise of clean air — these are still fireworks.

Fire safety checklist

- Burst crackers in an open area, never indoors or on a balcony near curtains.
- Keep a bucket of water and sand nearby; wear cotton clothes, not synthetics.
- Never relight a failed cracker; soak it in water and discard.
- Keep children and pets at a safe distance, and never hold a lit cracker in hand.
- Store crackers away from heat and flames; keep the stock outside the house.
- Switch off lights and fans that could spark near the bursting area.

Burn first-aid — do it right

For a minor burn, cool it under **running water for about 20 minutes**. Do not apply ice, toothpaste, butter or oil. Cover loosely with a clean, non-stick dressing. For any burn that blisters, is larger than the person's palm, or is on the face, hands or joints, see a doctor immediately. For eye injuries from sparks, do not rub — rinse gently and get medical help.

Pet-friendly Diwali

- Keep pets indoors in a quiet room with the windows closed during peak bursting hours.
- Dogs and cats hear far better than we do — loud crackers are genuinely distressing, not just annoying.

- Make sure collars and ID tags are on; scared pets can bolt when a door opens.
- Keep sweets, chocolates, raisins and onion or garlic dishes well away from pets — chocolate and raisins are toxic to dogs.
- For very anxious pets, talk to your vet before Diwali about calming options.

Air quality and the Delhi winter plan

Delhi's Winter Action Plan 2026-27 was announced on 29 September 2026 and includes measures from 1 November such as 50% work-from-home, doubled parking charges, a construction and demolition ban from 10 December to 20 January, and restrictions on non-BS-VI vehicles registered outside Delhi. If you are in the NCR, check the AQI on Diwali day, keep windows closed during peak bursting, and use a mask if you are in a sensitive group.

8 · The 6-Week Countdown Planner

Everything above, turned into a single week-by-week plan. Six weeks is enough time to do this calmly. Tick each item as you go — a printable version is in Chapter 10.

Week of	Do this
5 October	Set your budget tier and total (Chapter 2). Write your gift recipient list with a band for each. Note the prices of anything you want to buy in the sale.
12 October	Shop the Amazon Great Indian Festival (from 8 Oct) and Flipkart Big Billion Days (from 9 Oct). Order out-of-city gifts first. Buy non-perishable decor and lights.
19 October	Order customised or personalised gifts. Book any caterer or help. Start the declutter (one room a week).
26 October	Last safe window for standard gift delivery. Buy diyas, rangoli and toran. Plan your menu and confirm your guest count.
2 November	Buy fresh sweets, flowers and perishables. Deep-clean the home and set the puja area. Finalise the party prep timeline.
5-8 November	Decorate on 6-7 Nov. Light diyas from Dhanteras. Set out rangoli and puja thali. Host and celebrate. Check local cracker timings before Diwali night.

The one deadline to remember: Thursday, 5 November. Anything that must be delivered or handed over in person should be sorted by then, because Friday 6 November is the last working day before the festival.

9 · AI Assist — Plan Diwali Faster

You can plan most of Diwali in minutes with a general AI assistant. Copy a prompt below, replace the bracketed parts with your details, and paste it into the free tier of any assistant you already use — ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot or Claude. Then edit the output; treat it as a first draft, not the final answer.

1. Budget planner

You are a careful household budget planner in India. My total Diwali budget is ₹[amount] and my family has [number] members. Split it across gifts, clothes, decor, food and hosting, puja items, crackers and a buffer. Give me a table in rupees, and flag the two heads I am most likely to overspend on.

2. Gift shortlist

Suggest Diwali gifts for these recipients within these budgets: parents (up to ₹5,000), two colleagues (₹1,000 each), my domestic help (₹500), and a neighbour (₹700). Prefer useful, everyday items over sweets. Give one line on why each works.

3. Menu and quantities

Plan a Diwali dinner for [number] guests, mostly vegetarian, with one non-veg option. Give me a menu with a welcome drink, 4 starters, 2 mains, rice, bread, 2 sweets and sides, plus a per-guest quantity guide so I do not cook too much.

4. Hosting timeline

I am hosting [number] guests for Diwali dinner on 8 November 2026. Build me a 3-day preparation timeline, from shopping to serving, with times of day.

5. Decor on a budget

I have ₹[amount] for Diwali decor in a [size] home. Suggest a shopping list with approximate 2026 prices in rupees, plus three DIY ideas that look premium but cost almost nothing.

6. Invitation message

Write a warm, short Diwali party invitation message for WhatsApp in English, and a second version in [Hindi/Tamil/Marathi]. Include the date, time and place, and a line asking guests to confirm.

7. Leftover sweets

I have leftover Diwali mithai. Give me five quick recipes that reuse it (no extra shopping), with steps under 20 minutes.

8. Thank-you notes

Write three short Diwali thank-you messages for WhatsApp — one for a relative, one for a colleague, one for a neighbour — each under 40 words, warm and personal.

9. Rangoli ideas

Give me five simple rangoli designs I can draw with rice flour and flower petals in a small entrance area. Describe each in steps and the colours to use.

10. Corporate gifting plan

I need to gift [number] employees and [number] clients for Diwali on a ₹[amount] per-head budget. Suggest a tiered plan, and remind me of the ₹5,000 per-employee perquisite rule and the GST position on gifts.

11. Party games

Suggest five Diwali party games that work for a mixed group of adults, children and grandparents, needing no special equipment.

12. Post-Diwali reset

Give me a simple one-day plan to clean up after Diwali, store decor for reuse next year, and settle my festive spending against the budget I set.

Tip: always check an AI's numbers before you trust them — especially dates, prices and tax rules. Use it for the first draft, then verify against this playbook and official sources.

10 · Worksheets & Checklists

Print these pages or copy the tables into a notes app. Filling them in takes ten minutes and saves a great deal of festive stress.

A. My Diwali budget

Head	Planned (₹)	Actual (₹)	Difference

B. Gift tracker

Recipient	Gift	Budget (₹)	Ordered?	Delivered ?

C. Menu & quantity planner

Course / dish	Guests	Qty needed	Done?

D. Decor & shopping list

Item	Qty	Est. price (₹)	Bought?

E. 6-week checklist

- ☐ Budget tier and total decided
- ☐ Gift recipient list ready with bands
- ☐ Sale shopping done (Amazon / Flipkart)
- ☐ Out-of-city gifts ordered
- ☐ Customised gifts ordered
- ☐ Declutter started (one room a week)
- ☐ Decor and lights bought
- ☐ Menu and guest count finalised
- ☐ Fresh sweets and flowers bought
- ☐ Home deep-cleaned; puja area set
- ☐ Diyas, rangoli and toran in place
- ☐ Local cracker timings checked
- ☐ Fire-safety items ready (water / sand)
- ☐ Pet-safe quiet room arranged
- ☐ Party prep timeline confirmed
- ☐ Thank-you messages sent

Sources & Disclaimer

Dates, rules and price bands in this playbook were verified against the following sources in late September and early October 2026.

- Diwali 2026 dates and puja window — Drik Panchang; PanchangTime; Muhurat Choghadiya; ShubhPanchang.
- Festive sale dates — Amazon India (Great Indian Festival, from 8 October 2026); Flipkart (Big Billion Days, from 9 October 2026, early access 8 October); Livemint card-offer report (2 October 2026); Hindustan Times.
- Festive shopping behaviour — Integral Ad Science, Holiday Shopping India 2026 report (30 September 2026): 84% plan most or all festive shopping online; 38% plan to use AI for product and gift research.
- Gifting budget bands and corporate rules — Sumewam; Corpokit; Livehyv; CharmBox Diwali corporate gifting guides 2026 (perquisite ceiling Rule 3(7)(iv); ITC blocked under Section 17(5)(h), CGST Act).
- Gold buying and hallmarking — Bureau of Indian Standards (Hallmarking Amendment Regulations 2026, ₹75 per gold article from 14 September 2026); Hallmarking of Gold Jewellery and Gold Artefacts (Third Amendment) Order, 2026 (6 August 2026); BIS Care app.
- Firecrackers and air quality — Supreme Court order of 30 September 2026 (Arjun Gopal v. Union of India); CSIR-NEERI Gen-2 green cracker report; The Hindu, Indian Express, Times of India, LiveLaw reports (30 September – 1 October 2026); Delhi Winter Action Plan 2026-27 (29 September 2026).

Disclaimer

This playbook is a general planning guide. Price bands are indicative retail ranges and vary by city, quality and date. Firecracker rules, muhurat timings and government measures can change at short notice — always confirm the current position with your local authority, panchang and vendor before acting. Nothing here is legal, tax or financial advice; for those, consult a qualified professional.

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